individuals and as a team. Mark Boucher backed me up, and he also tried to get the point across that we can't afford to have a fear of failure – we have to go out there and express ourselves. As it turned out, the only South Africans who expressed themselves were Kevin Pietersen and Craig Kieswetter …

In our match against England, for example, Pietersen and Kieswetter came at our bowlers and really took the game to them, and our boys didn't know what to do. There was no Plan B – or if there was a Plan B, they were too shell-shocked to implement it. And I'm standing on the field watching, thinking to myself, 'Okay … here we go *again*!'

As soon as they took the attack to our bowlers, we were found wanting. We also took a couple of wickets off no-balls and dropped some catches, which didn't help. I know the guys don't mean to do it, but standing there on the field, I just think, 'It's a World Cup. This kind of stuff costs you big-time.'

And then in our do-or-die game against Pakistan, even our top batsmen played some pretty weird shots – look at the way a guy like AB de Villiers lost his wicket. Here's proof that even one of the game's best batsmen can play a silly shot – something that I have done plenty of times … that's just what pressure does. He'd been hitting back past the bowler superbly, but then went for a paddle-scoop over the keeper's head and ended up hitting straight into the air, to be caught by Pakistan keeper Kamran Akmal.

Lest you think I'm laying the blame at my teammates' door here, let me say that my own form was far from impressive as well. Against England, I was on eight when Ryan Sidebottom took a great catch at short fine leg to dismiss me; and then against Pakistan I hit a solid pull shot off Abdul Razzaq, but Misbah-ul-Haq managed to pluck the ball out of the air at mid-wicket. On another day it would've been a four. Unlucky? Maybe, but that's cricket. I guess on another day AB's paddle could've gone for four as well.

In that Pakistan game, chasing 148, we left the charge way too late and ended up 11 runs short. We were just too tentative, and despite our little team talk on the boat, again it basically came down to being scared. Look at the Aussies – they chased down 191 in their semi-final against the same Pakistani bowling attack with the ballsiest final two-over run chase I've seen in a long time.

As I said, this fear of failure is really reinforced by an essentially conservative strategic approach to the game. The Proteas' brain trust, for